In the next section, we'll dive into the different types of prompts you can use when interacting with AI models and especially when using the Vercel AI SDK.

5.1.2 Prompt types

In the context of the Vercel AI SDK, there are several types of prompts that can be used to interact with AI models. These prompt types—basic text prompts, message prompts, and system prompts—are designed to handle different scenarios and use cases. Additionally, a message prompt can be divided into several types: simple, compound (consisting of additional metadata or attachments), and tool call messages. Figure 5.3 illustrates this hierarchy of prompt types in the context of the Vercel AI SDK.

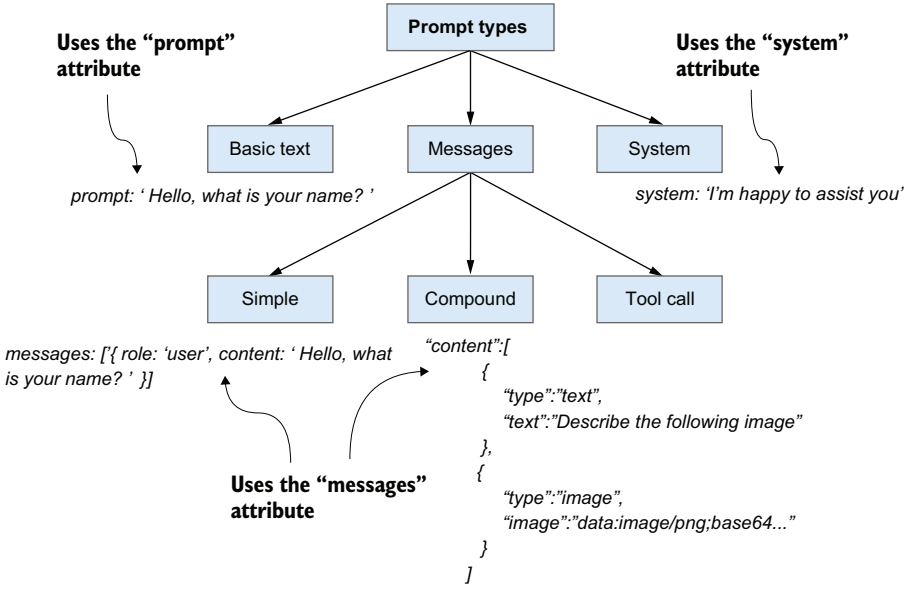


Figure 5.3 The classification of prompt types used in the Vercel AI SDK

BASIC TEXT PROMPTS

Basic text prompts are simple strings that contain instructions or questions for the AI model. They are straightforward and used for single-turn interactions using, for example, the `generateText` function:

```
generateText({
    prompt: 'Hello, what is your name?',
    model: model("models/gemini-2.0-flash")
});
```

This is essentially the same as using the messages field with a single message inside: